# Leanne Rhodes BAppSC(Comp) GDTheol MICDA

NGO & Network Director with 10+ Years International Experience
Counter Human Trafficking Leader with 13 Years Experience
Community Services Leader with 20+ Years Experience

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## Profile

A highly passionate leader in community services with expertise in NGO and network leadership. Actively administers, builds momentum, provides strategic oversight and governance, mobilises teams and creates systems to work out vision and mission. Best known for establishing quality programs and systems, clear communication, developing stakeholder partnerships, and finding creative solutions to problems.

## Key Professional Skills

- **Organisational Leadership** – Provides leadership in both established and new organisations, casting vision, building momentum and leading teams.
- **Systems Development** – Creates the systems and infrastructure needed for programs and organisational growth.
- **Stakeholder Engagement** – Facilitates collaborations across boundaries, building long lasting connections that foster trust and confidence.
- **Strategic Planning** – Offers a strategic mindset and develops and executes strategies in line with organisational vision and mission.
- **Project Management** – Leads projects from development to completion.
- **Team/Volunteer Mobilisation** – Able to mobilise teams and volunteers into action, providing clear communication and training to support goals.
- **International Experience** – Has worked internationally for over 12 years and has lived abroad in the UK, France, Romania and Portugal.

## Education and Training

**Bachelor of Applied Science (Computing)** | QUT
**Graduate Diploma in Theology** | Harvest Bible College
**Master of Arts** |Alphacrucis University College | Thesis to complete
**Chaplaincy Minister Upgrade** | Alphacrucis University College

## Career Summary

- **Program Manager . Administrator**
  iSEE CHURCH / iSEE CARE / iSEE COLLEGE — Feb 2025 – present
- **Strategic Solutions Director**
  The SlaveCheck Foundation — Jun 2023- Sep 2024
- **Executive Director**
  European Freedom Network — May 2019 – Dec 2023
- **Global Director & Founder**
  World Freedom Network |
  World Evangelical Alliance — Aug 2021 – Jul 2023
- **CEO & Founder**
  Abolishion (Australia, Romania & Portugal) — Dec 2012 - Present
- **International Worker (UK, France, Romania & Portugal)**
  ACC International — Dec 2011 – Dec 2023
- **Community Development / International Development Pastor**
  Bridge Church — Dec 2005 – Dec 2011
- **Technical Architect, Senior Analyst & Developer, Data Services, Team Lead**
  KAZ Technology Services — May 1999 – Dec 2005

## Professional Affiliations

**Ordained Ministers Credential**
Australian Christian Churches
2012 - Present

**Advocate Member**
Global Association of Human Trafficking Scholars
2020 – Present

**MICDA**
Australian Institute of Community Directors
2024 – Present

**Affiliate Member**
Chaplaincy Australia
2024 – Present

**Associate Member**
Queensland Disaster Chaplaincy Network
2024 – present

## Governance & Advisory Roles

**Non-Executive Director**
European Freedom Network
Feb 2024 – Feb 2026

**Chair**
Abolishion Inc.
Dec 2012 – Present

**Mission Executive**
(Board subcommittee)
Bridge Church
2008 – 2011

## Safety Credentials

**Blue Card:** 1373647 / 4 Type: P
Queensland Government
Expires: 02 September 2028

## Career Evolution

**Feb 2025 – Sep 2024**
**Strategic Solutions Director | The SlaveCheck Foundation**

Responsibilities:
- Set up administration systems for iSEE College and iSEE CHURCH.
- Coach lead pastors serving in an international context.
- Oversee international and local outreach for all 17 iSEE locations.
- Develop programs that can be outworked in all 17 iSEE locations.

Achievements:
- Designed and developed systems for managing iSEE COLLEGE enrolments.
- Designed and developed systems for managing mission trips at scale.
- Coached international lead pastors in financial management.

**June 2023 – September 2024**
**Strategic Solutions Director | The SlaveCheck Foundation**

Responsibilities:
- Build strategic partnerships for the foundation.
- Utilise knowledge of the anti-trafficking sector to inform product design and functionality.
- Project management.
- Represent and present for the foundation at key events including conferences and senate inquiries.

Achievements:
- Created policies and documentation to ensure Australian Charities and Non-Profit Commission (ACNC) registration as a Public Benevolent Institution (PBI).
- Lead, delivered and published the research project 'Recommendations for Helpline Design and Operation from People with Lived Experience of Modern Slavery.'

**May 2019 – December 2023**
**Executive Director | European Freedom Network (EFN)**

Responsibilities:
- Lead, grow and deliver the vision, mission and strategy of the network.
- Build partnerships with the wider church and particularly with the European Evangelical Alliance.
- Utilise partnership building and communications skills to represent the network amongst key stakeholders, including media and at a government level.
- Build the skills and capacity of network members.

Achievements:
- Lead the anti-trafficking response to the Ukraine War on five borders within 5 days, triggering 40 large international organisations to ask EFN to train them in the wider anti-trafficking response.
- Provided strategic advice and leadership to the European Evangelical Alliance on their response to the Ukraine War.
- Professionalised the network through rebranding, establishing it as a charity and building infrastructure for the network to grow from.
- Navigated EFN through the COVID period, creating infrastructure for online conferences run in multiple languages and helping EFN members navigate how to pivot to do secure online outreach to victims whilst protecting themselves from traffickers.
- Built key relationships with the Inaugural UK Anti-Slavery Commissioner and the Organisation for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE).
- Regularly invited to speak to media and conferences as an authority on human trafficking.

**August 2021 – July 2023**
**Global Director & Founder | World Freedom Network - World Evangelical Alliance**

Responsibilities:
- Create a global anti-trafficking network to support WEA's response to human trafficking.
- Work with the Public Engagement Department of the WEA to develop overall WEA goals.

Achievements:
- Established the team to build networks across Asia, South America, North America, Europe and the Middle East.
- Provided strategic advice for the WEA response to the Russian Invasion of Ukraine.
- Created opportunity and training for the Latino Forum Against Trafficking in Persons to submit a Universal Periodic Review for Argentina and Peru to the United Nations.

**December 2012 - Present**
**CEO & Founder | Abolishion (Australia, Romania & Portugal)**

Responsibilities:
- Found and develop the organisation, setting the vision and mission.
- Create avenues for fundraising to support the organisation and manage funds.
- Build an effective, professional and passionate team.
- Design and develop projects necessary to counter human trafficking.
- Provide governance and infrastructure for the organisation to build on.

Achievements:
- Established charities in Australia, Romania and Portugal.
- Formed a partnership with the Romanian anti-trafficking authority (ANITP) that allowed parts of the Romanian National Referral Mechanism (the policy that provides care and rights for survivors) to be rewritten.
- Created the Be Safe on Social Media program to help both primary and secondary students protect themselves from traffickers online. This program has been utilised in Romania, Australia, Portugal and Poland.
- Established women's emergency accommodation and social enterprise with support services for female survivors of human trafficking.
- Created effective media pieces that could be used to raise awareness of human trafficking.

**December 2011 – 2023**
**International Worker (UK, France, Romania & Portugal) | ACC International**

Responsibilities:
- Capacity building of local leaders.
- Work out vision and expertise of anti-trafficking work in Europe.
- Utilise ACCI funds in response to the Ukraine War.

Achievements:
- Served as an elder at Riverside International Church in Lisbon regularly preaching, establishing their small group discipleship program, and helping to navigate the COVID crisis.
- Worked alongside local organisations in Romania, Spain and Italy to train and coach women leaders.
- Led the Next Level International Network through a difficult restructuring time.

**December 2005 – December 2011**
**Community Development / International Development Pastor | Bridge Church (now Neuma Church)**

Responsibilities:
- Oversight and development of numerous departments over time including new people, local community outreach, small groups, internships, volunteers, leadership school, life skills school and global outreach.
- Strategic planning as part of the strategic team.
- Manage the community development arm of the church, both locally and globally, overseeing funds.
- Lead and develop leadership for teams of teams.

Achievements:
- Partnered with the local Vietnamese community to provide clean water for over 14,000 Vietnamese people finding refuge in Cambodia after war.
- Built long standing relationships with the Department of Human Services taking the church's relationship from non-existent to being a key stakeholder on the local housing estate.
- Increased the number of small groups from 30 to 50 in one year.

**May 1999 – December 2005**
**Technical Architect, Senior Analyst & Developer, Data Services, Team Lead | KAZ Technology Services**

Responsibilities:
- Communicate with and train staff in complicated technical systems.
- Work with methodologies and change management processes.
- Provide team leadership and mentoring.
- Understand, design and optimise complex data.
- Gain technical knowledge quickly and thoroughly and consistently advise team members on the best technical approach.

Achievements:
- Designed the architecture for a system to manage notifications for all Post Office boxes in Australia.
- Enabled 32 legacy systems to interface with one another at Australia Post.

Skills:
- Visual Basic
- SQL – SQL Server
- Interworld

## Publications

- Rhodes, L., & Doyle, A. (2024). *Recommendations for Helpline Design and Operations from People with Lived Experience of Modern Slavery*. The SlaveCheck Foundation. Available from https://www.slavecheck.org/helpline-recommendations
- Rhodes, L. M. (2016). Human Trafficking as Cybercrime. *Agora International Journal of Administration Sciences*, *1*(1), 23–29.

## Referees

Professional referees are available upon request.